

2016 Venous Blood Study (VBS) Version 2 Data Description: Appendix

I. Obtaining the Data

By downloading this freely provided data set, you agree to use its contents only for research and statistical purposes, making no effort to identify the respondents. You also agree to inform HRS of any papers, publications, or presentations based on this data set. You may send a bibliographical reference (including a URL link whenever possible) for each item to hqsquestions@umich.edu with "Attn: Papers and Publications" in the subject line. If possible, you should also include a PDF-formatted copy of the publication.

As an alternative, you may transmit publications in paper format by postal mail:

Health and Retirement Study
Attn: Papers and Publications
The Institute for Social Research, Room 3450
P.O. Box 1248
Ann Arbor, Michigan 48106-1248

A. Distribution Set

The *2016 Venous Blood Study (VBS) Version 2* data set is packaged for distribution in a ZIP file, **HRS2016VBSV2.zip**. The data file is keyed on HRS Household Identifier (HHID) and Person Number (PN). See Table 1 (below) for a description of the .zip file contents as well as a suggested subdirectory structure. If you have problems when downloading this data product or in extracting its contents, please contact the [HRS help desk](#).

Table 1: Contents of the Distribution Package			
Folders	Sub-Folders	File	Type
ascii	data	VBS16V2.da	Data file (ASCII text)
	sas	VBS16V2.sas	SAS program statements
	spss	VBS16V2.sps	SPSS program statements
	stata	VBS16V2.di/do	Stata dictionary and "do" files
built	Sas	VBS16V2.sas7bdat	SAS system file
	Spss	VBS16V2.sav	SPSS system file
	Stata	VBS16V2.dta	Stata system file
docs		HRS2016VBSV2DD.pdf	Data Description
		HRS2016VBSV2DD_appendix.pdf	Data Description Appendix (This document)
		VBS16V2.txt	Codebook file (ASCII text)

B. Build Instructions: Program Statements

Most users will wish to use the pre-built SAS, Stata, or SPSS versions of this dataset. If this is true for you, ignore the rest of this section.

Users who wish to build their own SAS, Stata, or SPSS file should extract the ASCII data file, the program statement file that matches the analysis environment, the data description (this file), and the codebook file.

Each data file comes with associated SPSS, SAS, or Stata program statements to read the data. Files containing SPSS statements are named with an .sps extension, those with SAS statements with an .sas extension, and those with Stata statements with .do and .dct extensions.

1. Using the Files with SAS

To create a SAS system file for this data set, load the .sas program statement files into the SAS Program Editor and reference the appropriate .da data files. If the *.sas file is located in 'c:\vbs\sas' and the data file is located in 'c:\vbs\data', you can run the file as is. A SAS system file will be saved to directory 'c:\vbs\sas'. If the files are not located in the specified directories, you will need to edit the *.sas file to reflect the proper path names prior to running the file.

2. Using the Files with SPSS

To create an SPSS system file for this data set, load the .sps program statement files into the SPSS syntax editor window, reference the appropriate .da data files, and select the *Run>All* option. If the *.sps file is located in 'c:\vbs\spss' and the data file is located in 'c:\vbs\data', you can run the file as is. An SPSS system file (*.sav) will be saved to directory 'c:\vbs\spss'. If the files are not located in the specified directories, you will need to edit the *.sps file to reflect the proper path names prior to running the file.

3. Using the Files with Stata

To use Stata with this data set, three file types must be present for that data set: .dct, .do, and .da. Files with the suffix ".da" contain the raw data for Stata to read. Files with the suffix ".dct" are Stata dictionaries used by Stata to describe the data. Files with the suffix ".do" are short Stata programs ("do files") which you may use to read in the data. Load the .do file into Stata and then submit it. If the *.do and .dct files are located in 'c:\vbs\stata' and the data file is located in 'c:\vbs\data', you can run the .do file as is. If the files are not located in these directories, you must edit the *.do and *.dct files to reflect the proper path names before you run the files.

C. Non-Windows Environments

Non-Microsoft users should modify the default Windows file structure syntax to match that of their own operating system. The following examples should work for both Macintosh OS X and any Unix/Linux distribution. Open the SAS program file(s), SPSS syntax file(s) or the Stata do/dct files in an ASCII editor and make the changes indicated below.

1. *SPSS in an OSX environment*

In this example, we assume that the user has downloaded the region dataset and placed the files in a **Desktop** folder called **vbs** with the ASCII data file stored in subfolder **data** and the syntax file in subfolder **spss**. Then the commands in the syntax file that accesses VBS16V2.da would be modified to look like this:

```
FILE HANDLE vbs /name='Desktop/vbs/data/VBS16V2.da' LRECL=464.
DATA LIST FILE= vbs/
HHID 1-6 (A)
[rest of syntax file goes
here] . execute.
SAVE /outfile 'Desktop/vbs/spss/VBS16V2.sav'. Execute.
```

2. *STATA in an OS X Environment*

In the following example we assume that:

- The username is “user1”
- The zip file containing tracker information has been downloaded to the user’s desktop from the HRS file download site
- The user has decompressed the zip file (use Stuffit for OS X) into a desktop folder named **vbs**
- The statistical package is stata

File HRS2016VBS.do should be modified as follows:

```
Change... infile using c:\vbs\stata\VBS16V2.dct
To... infile using /Users/user1/Desktop/vbs/stata/VBS16V2.dct

Change... save c:\vbs\stata\VBS16V2.dta
To... save /Users/user1/Desktop/vbs/stata/VBS16V2.dta
```

File VBS16V2.dct should be modified as follows

```
Change... dictionary using c:\vbs\data\VBS16V2.da {
To... dictionary using /Users/user1/Desktop/vbs/data/VBS16V2.da {
```

II. If You Need to Know More

This document is intended to serve as a brief overview to provide guidelines for using the *2016 Venous Blood Study (VBS) Version 2* data product. If you have questions or concerns that are not adequately covered here or on our Web site, or if you have any comments, please contact us. We will do our best to provide answers.

A. HRS Internet Site

Health and Retirement Study public release data and additional information about the study are available on the Internet. To access public data or to find out more about restricted data products and procedures, visit the [HRS Web site](https://hrs.isr.umich.edu).

B. Contact Information

If you need to contact us, you may do so by one of the methods listed below.

Internet: Help Desk at the HRS Web site (<https://hrs.isr.umich.edu/help>)

E-mail: hrsquestions@umich.edu

Postal Service:

Health and Retirement Study
The Institute for Social Research
426 Thompson Street, 3450 ISR
Ann Arbor, Michigan 48104